network, the network makes it harder to find the golden hash by increasing the number of zeros the hash is required to start with. This adjustment is made every 2,018 blocks, or every two weeks, with the target of miners finding a golden hash every 10 minutes, and thereby controlling the rate at which new bitcoin is minted. As a result, more and more people are competing for a smaller and smaller prize, which while still profitable for professional miners is largely out of reach of Bitcoin hobbyists. For perspective, the combined compute power of Bitcoin's network is over 100,000 times faster than the top 500 supercomputers in the world combined.[8]

Mining Beyond Bitcoin

While the strength of Bitcoin's mining network is legendary, most other cryptoassets are less daunting. If so inclined, mining within networks such as Ethereum, Zcash, and others is still open to enthusiastic and dedicated hobbyists, and none of these networks is dominated by ASICs (yet).[9] In fact, recall that one of the frequent adjustments subsequent assets made was to the block hashing algorithm to fight against centralization of miners. For that reason, ether, zcash, and many other cryptoassets are mostly mined wtih GPUs. As these assets grow in value, though, their mining networks become more competitive because the potential profit of getting paid in the native asset becomes more desirable. Conceptually, mining networks are a perfect competition, and thus as margins increase, new participants will flood in until economic equilibrium is once again achieved. Thus, the